

Frank Nowicki

RHEL / Enterprise Linux Architect · Platform Modernization · AWS Certified Solutions Architect

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SUMMARY

Enterprise Linux engineer with 20+ years administering Red Hat, CentOS, SUSE, and Solaris across development, test, and production for automotive, financial-services, and business-process-outsourcing customers. Repeatedly brought in to assess neglected or under-instrumented environments, identify operational risk, and turn them into stable, monitored, standardized platforms — then lead the migrations and upgrades that modernize them, with zero-data-loss cutovers as the track record. Consultative by background, from pre- and post-sales engineering and proof-of-concept work through Level 2/3 escalation and direct stakeholder communication. Red Hat administration and security training (SELinux, firewall, performance tuning), AWS Solutions Architect and SysOps Administrator certifications, and hands-on Docker/Kubernetes container-platform and serverless work.

CORE SKILLS

Red Hat & Enterprise Linux	RHEL and CentOS administration — patching and lifecycle management, kernel tuning, SELinux policy, firewall configuration, LVM and filesystem management, systemd, performance tuning and capacity analysis; also SUSE, Ubuntu, and Solaris 8–11
Containers & Platform	Docker and Kubernetes — cluster architecture concepts, node management, persistent storage, cluster networking, platform operations; OpenStack; serverless platform operations on Cloudflare Workers
Automation & Config Mgmt	Ansible, Puppet, Chef, Jenkins; standardized golden builds, provisioning automation, monitoring and alerting frameworks, CI/CD and release pipelines
Migration & Modernization	OS and platform upgrades, storage and backup platform migrations, environment consolidation, JumpStart/kickstart-style imaging and repeatable builds, production cutover planning and rollback
Cloud	AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, IAM, Backup) — Solutions Architect & SysOps Associate certified; Azure; Cloudflare Workers, KV, and Pages
Scripting & Automation Dev	Bash, Python (Django, Flask, Pandas, asyncio), Perl, PowerShell, C/C++, SQL
Storage, Network & DB	NetApp, EMC Celerra and Isilon; NFS, DNS, FTP/SFTP; Cisco routing and switching (OSPF, EIGRP, STP); Oracle 12c (certified DBA), PostgreSQL
Consulting & Advisory	Customer-facing technical advisory, environment assessment and risk reporting, technical presentations and proofs of concept, release coordination across test leads, project managers, and supplier resources

EXPERIENCE

Independent Cloud & Platform Developer — Self-Employed

2024 – Present · Remote

- Designed and operated a production serverless backend on Cloudflare Workers — authenticated endpoints, scheduled jobs, KV-backed state, and a server-side dead-man's-switch that delivers alerts when the user's device is powered off, verified end to end in unattended production testing.
- Re-architected a device-dependent notification path into a redundant server-side one using Twilio (carrier-grade SMS) and Cloudflare Email Sending (international delivery), eliminating a single point of failure in the alerting chain.
- Built and shipped **SafePulse**, a cross-platform personal-safety application, from first commit through production release — live on Google Play and the Amazon Appstore, with further store submissions in progress.
- Automated release delivery through the Google Play Developer API and Gradle Play Publisher using Workload Identity Federation, satisfying an organizational security policy that prohibits long-lived service-account keys.
- Managed build flavors, signing keys, and versioning across five independent release pipelines, each with its own review, signing, and compliance requirements; stood up a remote Linux/macOS build pipeline over SSH from a Windows/WSL workstation.

Career Break — Family Caregiving & Professional Development

2017 – 2023

- Full-time caregiver for a family member while maintaining and deepening technical skills through structured certification study.
- Completed **Red Hat Enterprise Linux administration and security training** — SELinux policy, firewall configuration, service hardening, monitoring, and performance tuning — alongside Docker, Kubernetes, Puppet, and Python automation coursework.
- Earned **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate** and **AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate** (2018), and **Oracle Database 12c Administrator Certified Professional** (2019–2020, 4.0 GPA).

Senior Unix/Linux System Administrator — SourceHOV

Oct 2011 – Jan 2017 · Troy, MI

- Inherited a neglected, failure-prone enterprise Unix/Linux estate; assessed it end to end, set configuration and operational standards, and rebuilt it into a stable, predictable, monitored platform.
- Reduced monthly incident volume from roughly 300 tickets to 80 through root-cause analysis, proactive remediation, and reprioritization of recurring failure classes.
- Designed and implemented system-monitoring and alerting for mail, web, and FTP services, introducing process-threshold management where none existed.
- Led a migration of 600+ users to a new secure FTP platform and relocated multiple file systems onto EMC Isilon — both cutovers completed with zero data loss.
- Automated user-account provisioning, cutting a manual two-hour process to twenty minutes and removing a standing source of configuration drift.

Unix System Administrator — TEKsystems (Contract)

May 2007 – Jan 2008 · Warren, MI

- Built and maintained a production-parity test environment covering patch levels, security configuration, telecom access, and kernel tuning — the validation gate for changes headed to production.
- Coordinated release scheduling and readiness across test leads, project managers, and external supplier resources.

Unix System Administrator — Incentra Solutions / DaimlerChrysler (SHAP)

Apr 2005 – Nov 2006 · Sterling Heights, MI

- Led migration of UNIX and Windows clients from NetBackup to NetVault across a Solaris 2.6–9 estate — a full backup-platform modernization executed against live plant operations.
- Deployed network-attached storage appliances protecting plant servers across multiple Chrysler facilities; administered Linux-based GuardianOS, DNS, and NFS as the embedded on-site technical resource.

Unix System Administrator — LaSalle Bank (Contract)

Jun 2004 – Jan 2005 · Troy, MI

- Automated EMC Celerra volume creation and replication with Bash and rsync; built mirrored volumes with Solstice DiskSuite in a regulated financial-services environment.
- Standardized Solaris 8 provisioning through JumpStart imaging and scripted post-installation configuration — repeatable builds in place of hand-configured hosts.

Systems Engineer — Pre/Post-Sales — Technical Solutions, LLC

Jun 1997 – Jun 2003 · Troy, MI

- Customer-facing technical advisor across the sales cycle: requirements discovery, technical presentations, proofs of concept, product integration into client environments, and Level 2/3 escalation support.
- Translated business requirements into implementable technical designs and supported customers through deployment and ongoing operations.

WHAT COLLEAGUES SAY

"Frank was the senior Unix admin when I worked with him at SourceHOV. He expertly fixed a neglected Unix environment, proactively configured systems so they no longer failed, and added value by putting monitoring in place and setting standards. Under his leadership it became a stable, predictable platform. He is one of the very best Unix admins I have worked with and would be a benefit to any company that hires him."

— Steve Allison, Backup and Recovery Engineer · worked with Frank at SourceHOV

"Frank is an awesome System Administrator. Professional. Effective. Solution-oriented. Looking forward to working with Frank again soon."

— Kuldip Bhatt, Senior Technology & CRM Operations Leader

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

- **Red Hat Enterprise Linux administration & security training** — SELinux, firewall configuration, monitoring, performance tuning
- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate** (2018) · **AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate** (2018)
- **Oracle Database 12c Administrator Certified Professional** (2019–2020, 4.0 GPA) — Global Institute of Information Technology
- **Cisco Certified Entry Networking Technician (CCENT)** — Cisco Networking Academy
- **Associate of Applied Science, Information Technology** — Macomb Community College
- **Unix/C Certificate Program** — Marygrove College: Unix system and network administration, shell scripting, C programming